Day 01 - Saturday 10/03/2026

Monday, August 3, 2026 2:05 PM

FLIGHT FROM SACRAMENTO TO NEW YORK :
SMF LGA Sacramento to NYC (LaGuardia)

Woke up pretty early, at 4:00am. Got some coffee, toast and muffin and was reminded that it was Janet's birthday. I would have remembered it eventually, I think. Anyway, it was too early but got everything in order and left for the airport at 8:30am.

TSA went smoothly and we were ready to board, but we had about an hour. So we waited.

Sacramento SMF to Chicago MDW
The flight to Chicago was without any complaints. Had some snacks and sodas. That was about it.

Chicago MDW to New York (LaGuardia) LGA
Not too much to report on the flight into LaGuardia. After we landed and stopped at the gate everybody got up to gather their things. Then, the pilot announced that everyone had to sit back down as he had overshot the stop point and they had to push the plane back a little bit. After a few minutes the plane had been pushed back enough so that everyone could resume their deplaning.

Go Airlink NYC

Date Time 03 October 2026 - 7:30 PM
Confirmation: 894571
Sisson, Russell Passenger 2 Bags 2 People
Phone 530.575.7921
Car Type Economy Sedan
Pick-Up LGA Airport, Southwest Airlines Texas - WN 995, from MDW. Arriving to terminal B. Outside the terminal pickup.
Drop-Off FAIRFIELD BY MARRIOTT INN & SUITES NEW YORK MANHATTAN/CENTRAL PARK: 538 W 58 St (10 Ave / 11 Ave) 10019
Instructions SEE EMAIL ON WHERE TO MEET, ETC.

We had the hardest time getting to our ride. We didn't know where we were supposed to find the car and the email didn't say where either. After trying a couple of different places Janet finally called the person and they were not in the airport yet. Sounded like it was a Uber ride. We finally met up with the person and proceeded to our hotel. He was simply following GPS but it seemed like it was taking forever.

New York (check-in)

Fairfield by Marriott Inn & Suites New York Manhattan/Central Park
538 West 58th Street New York, New York 10019 USA

The room is on the top floor but it seems pretty small. Nice view, with all the lights, especially since it was around 9:00pm and dark. We were hungry so we ended up at The Greek Kitchen, which was about to close. It was just up the street and on the corner. We shared the Gyro platter which was very good and plenty for the two

of us. The place was closing so we had to hurry but we left to go back to the hotel feeling better.

Day 02 - Sunday 10/04/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:22 AM

Fairfield by Marriott Inn & Suites New York Manhattan/Central Park
The room was ok, but I didn't sleep much. The room air conditioner was loud so I turned it off around 1:30am and it seemed to stay cool enough. Didn't help the sleeping though.

The free breakfast was good but didn't have any pastries that I liked. Plenty of other breakfast items though, such as eggs and sides, cereals, fruit, coffee, juices, etc.

VIATOR EXCURSION 2:00PM

Half-Day Bus Tour of NYC Top Highlights

Booking Ref: 1434723033
Meeting Point: 822 8th Ave, New York, NY 10019, USA
Please meet us on 8th Avenue between West 49th and West 50th Streets, across from World Wide Plaza. Make sure you're standing on 8th Avenue (not on the side streets). Our friendly team will be there to check you in.

The tour ended up being quite late and it was raining so it didn't start out well. They were at least a half hour late and there were a lot of people waiting in the rain. The tour itself was not up to par, traffic was horrible, the road was rough and there was a Polish parade which closed a number of streets the tour was to take. There was construction and scaffolding everywhere, and I mean everywhere. The windows inside the bus (or more like it, a large van) started to steam up and you could not really see the sights being pointed out. Plus, bathroom breaks were not clearly scheduled so for over 5 hours we kept rolling along. The tour guide was not very good and was really not worth listening to by the time the tour ended. He tended to include his own personal thoughts and life a lot, which we really didn't want to hear. I guess the one upside is that we got to go to Brooklyn and other Burroughs we probably wouldn't have gone to otherwise.

The weather was not cooperating, but we did get to stop at various places. For example, we were able to see the 911 Memorial and also get a glimpse of the Statue of Liberty. The 922 Memorial is especially memorable but we really didn't get a whole lot of time there.

We walked back to the hotel in the light rain and got some wine before heading to bed.

Day 03 - Monday 10/05/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:22 AM

Fairfield by Marriott Inn & Suites New York Manhattan/Central Park

Not a very good night for me again, although Janet slept pretty good until about midnight and then was pretty iffy the rest of the night. I think she probably heard the same thing I heard, which sounded like some room next door dropping something to the floor. Very loud. Got up around 6:00am.

Went down and had our free breakfast. About the same except they had sausage (actually sliced up hot dog) and some blueberry bites as a form of scones. Obviously, bought from the store in bulk. We both had some eggs, sausage, scones and yogurt with toppings.

Next we walked up to Central Park. The weather was better. The Park itself is very large and full of trees and ponds. The main thing you notice is that there are set places for runners and bikers. Walkers must stay in their own lanes. Lots of people and dogs, either way. We found strawberry fields across from The Dakotas where John Lennon was killed. We walked to the Belvedere Castle which had a lot of stairs and is not really a castle. I didn't go up the last bit of stairs but ended up having to go up anyway in order to get to the Met Museum. That's where we were really heading after all.

The Metropolitan Museum of Art

E Ticket (check email)
Order Information: Senior Admission | $22.00 (per person)
Order Number: 62403913 Customer Number: 8603521
Total: $44.00 (PAID 09/27/2026)

Anyway, we made it to the Metropolitan Museum. Had to go to the bathroom, so that was handy. Very nice museum with a lot of artifacts and paintings. Could have spent the whole day inside.

Then we took a bus to the Central Train Station. Nice large and old building. The so-called market was a bust.

We walked around a bit and found the restaurant recommended by Heather so we had lunch. Plenty of Italian food, tasted good. It was called Carmine's. The to-go bag had a different logo, so we were not quite sure of its true name or ownership. We finished what we could and then proceeded to go back to the hotel. On the way, we split up. Janet went to find J.Jill. I went back to the hotel.

Resting here while I wait for Janet. Janet came back after purchasing a few items from J.Jill. She thought the store was awfully small for being in New York.

We waited until Happy Hour (5:00pm) and then went downstairs for our wine. After finishing the wine we walked up to The Greek Kitchen. Janet had the lemony soup and I just had the dessert Galaktoboureko. It was good but not as good as the one we had in Greece.

After that, we went back to the hotel to check in for the night.

Day 04 - Tuesday 10/06/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:23 AM

Fairfield by Marriott Inn & Suites New York Manhattan/Central Park
(check-out)

Arranged to get a ride to the cruise ship from the hotel. About $66 dollars. Probably worth it, given the traffic problems and not secure about the subway. We were able to get the ride early, about 10:30am and it was wise to do so because it took a long time to get to the Brooklyn terminal.

Tuesday, Oct 6, 2026 - Saturday Oct 17, 2026
OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA - Embarkation
BROOKLYN CRUISE TERMINAL Embarkation
210 CLINTON WHARF
BROOKLYN, 11231, NY, UNITED STATES

The embarkation process was a nightmare. They switched the embarkation location a couple of weeks before we set sail. We had made specific hotel reservations in Manhattan, in close proximity to the expected embarkation location. Then, they switched it to Brooklin, which required a ride across town.

Also, they had closed the restaurant Jacque's for the Celiac people. That was OK, but it was talked about not being good for ALL the guests. They tried to include some of the dishes in the GDR, but it was not the same.

Once we finally got there we didn't know what to do with our luggage, so we took it with us. There were long lines, kind of like Disneyland. There were various things that were required to be entered online. This was in order to get your boarding pass. Things that they required you do online beforehand were not necessary. They asked for the same information again, but you had to wait in another line for that. The Oceania representative behind the desk was forced to deal with one or more guests at a time. For example, the pictures that were required online were not used and they just took them over again. They were completely overwhelmed it seemed. They could have had you fill out the Canada stuff online, but no. Anyway, the process was broken no two ways about it.

Once we got on board, things improved of course. The food for lunch was good, but typical. The ship Vista is a definite improvement over Marina. It's a beautiful ship. Lots of elegance and niceties. I guess the real bonus out of embarking from Brooklyn was the Statue of Liberty. Great views!

Once we got to our room things also improved. The room seems more spacious, mainly due to the lighter colors and the reduced size of the desk. The bathroom also seems more spacious with the elimination of the tub and the larger shower. This is a newer ship than the Marina and it shows.

Reserved RED GINGER: 6:30 PM
Met two other couples at dinner, sitting at our table of 6. The food was not that good and the service was very slow. The other two couples were of similar opinion, with one couple leaving early. Knowing how good Oceania food can be it was quite a

disappointment for all of us. We were told that there was some kind of issue in the kitchen that was effecting everyone. That was helpful, but not a good sign though.

I think that will be the last time for Red Ginger. We went away without dessert and back to our room to get ready for bed.

Day 05 - Wednesday 10/07/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:24 AM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA
Woke up around midnight not feeling that well. Went to pee and that seemed to help but I had a hard time falling to sleep. Janet and I got out of bed around 5:00am. Janet went to get some coffee. We each took our showers and then headed up to deck 12 for breakfast. Tried a little lighter menu for breakfast. Seemed to help the full feeling.

Newport, Rhode Island, United States Anchor

We took the early tender and got a head start on everybody else. Just about 10 in the boat. The tender is much nicer than the tender on Marina. We walked about 2 blocks and found the transit center. Turns out there is a bus 67 that is free. We took that one to the place where you start the walk along the cliff. It takes you right along the cliff but in front of some very rich looking private residences and university houses. The trail is mostly paved but there are some places where it can get quite treacherous. I stopped here, but Janet went on a little further. When Janet came back, we turned around and walked back.

On the way back we both had to pee. I found a tree and later Janet found a real bathroom. We also found the sign where you have to be for the return 67 bus to stop. We waited and waited and it eventually came and picked us up. It took us back to the central station within easy walking distance to the tender.

We got back to the ship and ate lunch out on the terrace. Filled us up enough to put us to sleep for an afternoon nap.

Attended a talk on Boston by a naturalist. She also talked about whales. Apparently, we should be on the lookout in Boston harbor for humpback whales.

We attended the Captains toast with free drinks and appetizers. It was good but the way it was configured it made it very difficult to see or hear what was being said. For example, the bar is in the center with the stage off to the side. The pillars get in the way of seeing the stage.

After that we went to dinner at GDR. Didn’t really need the food but couldn’t pass up the opportunity.

Went back to the room to get ready for bed.

Day 06 - Thursday 10/08/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:25 AM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Boston, Massachusetts, United States

Took the Oceania free shuttle bus to the Aquarium and walked the Freedom Trail through the town. The street or sidewalk is marked so you know which street to take. Lots of sights, walking and old buildings. Mostly, tourist stops. The trail was well marked, although there were a few spots where a detour was required due to construction. We didn't have a whole lot of time, so it didn't take too long.

We were going to stop and have a drink at one of the pubs, but nature called. We then walked to where we took the free bus shuttle back to the ship.

Reserved TOSCANA: 7:00 PM
We ate at Toscana for dinner with four other people. The food was good and so was the service. Not sure what happened at Red Ginger.

Most of the conversation was pretty standard but towards the end of dinner the one couple (Hal and Diane) started to talk about Diane's issues. She announced that she had been diagnosed with Alzheimer's. We had noticed that Hal was kind of gently guiding her along through dinner. Anyway, the dinner ended but Janet kind of stepped in to comfort Diane.

We hadn't started dinner until our 7:00pm reservation so we went back to our room to get ready for bed. It was well past 9:00pm by then.

Day 07 - Friday 10/09/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:25 AM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Saint John (Bay of Fundy), New Brunswick, Canada

The time changed overnight so we lost an hour. Getting every device back in sync was a challenge.

We had a light pastry and coffee up on Barrista's and then went down to the Terrace buffet for breakfast. There is no Bakery at Barristas on Marina, so it was nice to see the separate section on Vista. There really wasn't much of a difference though in the bakery items available. It was nice having our bakery item along with a real cappuccino, instead of the one out of the machine.

I wasn't feeling up to par so Janet headed out by herself to the town. That will be the first scope, since we will be here for two days. Tomorrow we will check out where the highest tides in the world are and see the river reverse itself. It rained a bit while Janet was gone so it could rain tomorrow.

Reserved POLO: 6:30 PM

Dinner at Polo was just OK. We met up with Hal and Diane so we sat at a table for four together. Dinner was average but Janet did talk some more with Diane about her diagnosis. We enjoyed their company but it was a little too much. We will probably see them again before the trip is over.

After dinner we went back to the room to get ready for bed as it was already after 9:00pm.

Day 08 - Saturday 10/10/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 11:26 AM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Saint John (Bay of Fundy), New Brunswick, Canada

We spent the night here in Saint John. Got up early, even though we had the morning to get off the ship. We went to visit the Reverse Tide but the tide was not very low so we didn't see any of the reverse action. Spent a lot of time waiting for the tide to do something. Didn't do much. The tide was definitely coming in, but not the reverse tide that was talked about. It was very windy and cold though. We walked up to a park at the top of the hill, looking for some sun.

We came back to the ship and Janet decided she wanted to go back shopping some more. So she did and I read by the pool again.

For dinner we decided to try the Canadian Market dinner being put on in the Terrace Café. It was supposed to be Canadian and French themed but it wasn't that good. We ate some other things and then headed back to the room to get ready for bed.

Day 09 - Sunday 10/11/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:02 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada

We cruised into Halifax in the AM but couldn't get off the ship until 11:30am.

We ate breakfast at the GDR. Nice table but the service wasn't good. I ordered granola and avocado toast. Janet ordered crepes, which were good. But the avocado toast didn't show up until after we were done. So, I sent it back. We got a phone call from the GDR later apologizing and inviting us back but too little and too late. Plus, it showed how much they keep track of everyone on board.

By this time I was ready to give all of Oceania a bad review since they were asking how our trip was going. The embarkation process was bad. The first night's dinner at Red Ginger was bad, the Internet was bad, the pastry was dry and tasteless, etc.

We walked off the ship and walked a long way uphill to the Citadel. The Citadel being at the top of a hill. There was supposed to be an entrance fee but nobody was around. The fortress itself has a lot of rooms or I guess barracks. Plenty of canons to shoot out over the harbor. This was another British and French back and forth war. The Citadel is the star shaped fortress that was to protect Halifax. It was never really tested as a fortress but the British and French ran it at various times, after brief battles and lots of loss of life.

We walked back to the ship and had some lunch at Waves. My Reuben sandwich was not very good. The meat was pretty fatty and tough. So, I just gave up and had ice cream instead. Even the ice cream could be better. My opinion, Humphry Slocumbe is not as good as say Umpqua or Tillamook. Janet decided to go back out and do some more shopping but she came back early saying she was worn out by the wind.

We decided to try the GDR for dinner. It was pretty good, but crowded. I think most of people did not like the previous night at the Terrace special, so they ended up here tonight. Anyway, it was crowded but good we got there right when they opened up.

After dinner we listened to some music, jazz, and then went back to the room to get ready for bed.

Day 10 - Monday 10/12/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:02 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Sydney, Nova Scotia, Canada Anchor

According to onboard itineraries Sydney was NOT an anchor. But as it turned out, the weather played a role. In fact, because of 30 knot winds they canceled Sydney altogether. Janet had heard that there was not a tug available and there were 3 cruise ships all traveling to Sydney. Just so happens that today is a holiday, Thanksgiving in Canada, so I think that had something to do with it as well. So, we are waiting to see what they are going to do, but we are definitely not going to Sydney.

We had some light lunch. They have decided to officially cancel Sydney and make this an unofficial sea day. Janet's going for a short walk around downstairs and then we are going to watch a movie. This one with Ryan Gosling called Project Hail Mary is 2 1/2 hours long.

A very good movie. Janet didn't even fall asleep!

The weather has gotten a whole lot worse. Ship seems to be doing fine, but the waves are pretty huge. I wouldn't be surprised if they cancel Corner Brook as well. According to the weather, Corner Brook is expecting snow and a high only in the high 40s.

We ended up going to GDR for dinner. Frankly, the food is getting to be the same. It's good food, but the variety is missing. Anyway, we had a good dinner, listened to some string music and then went to room to get ready for bed.

Day 11 - Tuesday 10/13/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:03 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Corner Brook, Newfoundland, Canada

Woke up this morning and decided just to eat something at Baristas and have a cappuccino.

We left the ship early, but it was quite cold. There was a bus to take us into town. There was a pharmacy store right where the bus dropped us all off. Janet discovered some small decorations called the mummers. From there, we found a trail. The trail went through a wooded area but it was very cold. Mainly from the wind. We took a short hike and headed back to the ship to get warm and have some lunch. Later, Janet then headed back out to shop some more.

Lunch was nice, but not much to it. I stayed back and walked around a bit before heading back to the room with a glass of wine. Before I left the Terrace, I saw Hal and Diane and talked with them a bit.

Janet came back onboard and we decided to eat dinner at the Terrace. Mostly, whatever looked good. Then we listened to some string music and went back to room to go to bed.

Day 12 - Wednesday 10/14/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:03 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Cruising the St. Lawrence River

Another sea day, this time planned. Started out very nice but throughout the day the weather got worse.

We ended up watching another movie. This time it was Disclosure Day. Another science fiction but Janet ended up reading and just watching the beginning and the end. The ending was interrupted by Trivia down in the Vista Lounge, which is really the theater. The movie was almost over anyway (another one of those 2 plus hour movies that don't really need to be that long).

So we went to Trivia, came back to the room for a while and then took off for the cocktail party for Oceania Club Members. Free drinks, but that was about it. So we left for the GDR and sat at a table with one other couple. They were not really a couple, but were singles who became friends on this trip. Susan and Jim. Susan was from Switzerland and Jim was from Pleasant Grove in California. Susan was doing the best she could at conversation in English. Jim was in his 80's and showed it through his statements. Frankly, I don't know what Susan saw in Jim.

After dinner we went back to our room and got ready for bed.

Day 13 - Thursday 10/15/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:04 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Saguenay, Quebec, Canada Anchor

Actually newly listed as a non-anchor day and we ended up at the dock at 9:00am. Saguenay is located way up at the end of a fork off of the river. More of a fjord, if you will. The colors on the steep cliffs are gorgeous and the town looks pretty quaint. Reminds us a lot of the fjords in Norway. It is very cold here, as the high is only expected to be in the high 30's. It did in fact lightly snow the day before.

We got off of the ship and found a tour that is about 4 hours and takes you through part of the National Park. Nice ride through town and through the back country. The guide was so-so but the scenery was good. Hopefully got some good pictures of the fjord and fall leaves. The very red maples had all pretty much lost their leaves in the last storm but the yellows were very present.

We ended the tour with a stop to get coffee. I think people thought the tour company had arranged for the coffee but not. Oh well.

We ended the tour in time for a glass of wine at Waves. Everything else was closed.

The ship had its final and last entertainment show before dinner. Lots of singing and dancing. Instead of having bingo they had the last show of the cruise at around 5:00pm. Great time for most of the people since they were usually in bed by 9:00pm. Maybe Oceania will learn from that or they were just trying to promote their later entertainment venue that usually comes later.

Went to dinner at the GDR. Running out of menu items, but the chicken item was good.

After dinner we went back to our room and got some reading in before bed.

Day 14 - Friday 10/16/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:04 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA

Quebec City, Quebec, Canada

Very wet and cold but we ventured out anyway. We went up the Funicular and stopped in at the Fairmont Hotel. We were advised that they only took cash (Canadian cash at that). Turns out the guy was very nice and took US dollars. The hotel is quite the spectacle. It was all very nice and pretty but it was getting wetter, windier and colder by the minute. So we decided to head back to the ship.

We did do the things most tourists do, such as:
Quartier Petite Champlain. Short funicular takes you up to the "upper town" and the Fairmont.
Fairmont Le Chateau Frontenac
Quartier Petite Champlain

Other than that, no pictures. Got back to the ship and tried to get warmed up and dry. If it stops raining or gets less windy, we might go back out again.

Our bags are on the bed expecting to be packed. Maybe later.

Janet did venture out one more time. It's been rainy and cold all day long. We went to the last Trivia and then back to the room to await dinner at the GDR.

We will be departing Quebec Cite early. Instead of 7:00pm it will now be 5:00pm. This is due to the tides in order to allow for the necessary clearance needed below the two bridges of Ponte de Quebec and Pierre La Porte during the low tide period in the St Lawrence River.

Day 15 - Saturday 10/17/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:05 PM

OCEANIA CRUISE VISTA - Disembarkation

Oceania Cruises' Vista disembarks at the Port of Montreal (Grand Quay). The address is 200 De la Commune Street West, Montreal, QC H2Y 4B2.
We slept pretty well. Got up our usual 5:00am, took showers, finished packing and went upstairs to the Terrace for our final breakfast.

We disembarked about 8:00am and made our way to our Montreal hotel. Not very far from the port of disembarkation. Easy walk.

My overall comments on the cruise: Embarkation was way too difficult. I would say that there were quite a few people with walkers or riding scooters or wheelchairs. Pretty tottery bunch. There was one passenger a few days ago who left on an ambulance. Not sure what his status is or was. The ship Vista is really nice (especially the upgraded bathrooms) but there seemed to be less food in the buffet and less actual staff to wait on the guests. There was the same ratio of staff to guests, but more "generals" and less staff the help the guests. "Finest Cuisine at Sea" has become just a slogan.

Montreal, Canada
Eurostars Old Montreal Suites & Apartments (check-in)
300 Rue du Saint-Sacrement, Montreal, QC, H2Y2R4 Canada

THINGS TO DO:
Old Montreal
Notre Dame Cathedral
Jacques Cartier Square
Bonsecours Market
Port
William Gray Hotel

Checked out our hotel and since it is very early we knew the room would not be ready. They were able to store our luggage and we went on our way to explore. Not a whole lot to see and it is very cold. But at least it is not raining.

We went back to the hotel hoping that they would have the room available but it wasn't ready yet. So we sat. In the meantime a small family was checking out. The young boy (probably around 5 or 6) went up to the fire alarm and pulled it. The whole place was a buzz, the alarm was screaming and the management had no idea what to do. Eventually, the firemen showed up but about all they could do was stop the alarm, which left the elevators non-working. Again, the management had a no idea what to to do.

We finally got our room cleaned, but we had to walk ourselves and our luggage up the stairs to the top floor (which was to the 7th floor). It is a nice large apartment, with two bedrooms and a kitchen. Each bedroom just has a queen sized bed. We picked a bedroom and left the other untouched. Anyway, we had our glass of wine from Oceania and are waiting to head to a grocery store for some food.

We finally found an IGA grocery store that had what we needed. There was another, closer, small grocery store, but it was less selective and more expensive. Anyway, we got what we needed and went back to our room. Yea for us, the elevators were working again.

We went out to dinner to a place close by that Janet had spotted. There was hardly anybody there but then it got really busy. One, was a large group of mainly guys that (according to the manager) were there mainly for the cheap drinks before going to some Montreal sporting event. The other group was for some rehearsal wedding dinner that we happened to see outside our hotel taking pre-pictures. Anyway, it got busy and noisy very quickly.

We came back to the room to get ready for bed. This cold and wind is very tiring.

Day 16 - Sunday 10/18/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:06 PM

Eurostars Old Montreal Suites & Apartments

Woke up about 5:00am this morning. There was some noise during the night but not too bad. Mostly from those celebrating some sports event. Also, it was Saturday night so things can be noisy.

We have this spacious place to stay. Unfortunately, there isn't much storage for anything. The bathroom is overly spacious, but no place for towels, etc. Seems as if we started out small in New York City, got a little larger on the ship and then this spacious two bedroom apartment here in Montreal.

We ate some of the yogurt and raspberry bread for breakfast with our coffee. The stuff we got from the grocery store. This place has a real coffee maker and enough coffee to make a pot. Things are pretty quite this morning.

We tried to take public bus to the park high above the city (Park Mount Royal and viewing deck is Kondiaronk Belvedere) but the bus driver was very rude and would not take anything but exact coins. So, we walked back to the hotel, downloaded the Uber app and arranged for a ride instead. So much easier and only a few dollars more than the public bus.

The park is very beautiful with all the fall trees. The view of Montreal is incredible, although there were a lot of people doing the same thing. We then walked down over 300 stairs to get to the bottom where we could walk back to the hotel. We stopped along the way to grab a sandwich and drink.

After resting back at the hotel for a while, we went to dinner at a place that was very unusual in its appearance. The name of the place is L' Usine De Spaghetti. The food was Italian, mainly spaghetti, etc. Average at best. The foot traffic has really picked up. A lot of people and families out for a stroll.

We walked back to the hotel to read and get ready for bed. Along the way we found the William Gray Hotel. Nothing that special about it. But we do need to get to the top for a drink.

Day 17 - Monday 10/19/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:06 PM

Eurostars Old Montreal Suites & Apartments

Woke up early again, about 5:00am. Things are a little different outside. This is a workday. So more lights on. The streets are busy with cars and work trucks. We had our coffee. Janet had her leftover spaghetti and I had some more yogurt and raspberry bread.

We were hoping to get to the dome today in the old World's Fair, but it is closed on Mondays. So we will try to get to the old Olympic village instead. Holding off a little because of the cold. So, Janet decided to do some laundry. The place comes with a washer and dryer.

Turns out most of what we wanted to see is closed today. So, instead, we will backtrack our way back to a shopping area that we spotted yesterday. So, no Uber needed today.

We walked back to the area that is blocked off for pedestrians. Didn't really go into any stores. There was an area where musicians played, so we stopped for a little while. Came back to the hotel.

Ate dinner at a crepe shop. It was ok, nothing special. Came back to hotel to read, watch some more of Nashville on TV and get ready for bed.

Day 18 - Tuesday 10/20/2026

Tuesday, August 4, 2026 1:07 PM

Eurostars Old Montreal Suites & Apartments (check-out)

Overall, Montreal is another city trying to be more like New York City. There seems to be a lot of tall buildings and a lot of homeless lining the streets and parks.

We got up early again, around 5:00am. Finished off the food we had bought for breakfast, took a short walk to the harbor and finished packing. Janet decided to make one final walk up to the shopping area. Just waiting to notify Uber and check out.

FLIGHT TO SACRAMENTO USA FROM MONTREAL–TRUDEAU INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT:

Montreal, QC, CA (YUL) to Washington, DC, US (IAD)
Flight was pretty uneventful. The Montreal airport is very smooth. There were no lines and our bags were checked all the way through to Sacramento. They have a whole terminal at the airport just for US passengers, thus there is no need to pick up your luggage in DC and then walk it over. They get around this by having US customs in Montreal so you don't have to do it again in DC.

We did get a small snack item along with a soda or juice on the flight, even though it was a short flight.

Washington, DC, US (IAD) to Sacramento, CA, US (SMF)
The flight from DC was pretty much a nightmare. The row in front of me had a screaming kid for two hours at least. I mean full out screaming and thrashing the whole time. The young kid completely wore out the whole plane, not to mention her parents and us. After about 2 1/2 hours the kid finally gave in to sleep for the rest of the 2 1/2 hour flight into Sacramento. It wasn't too long though before another kid nearby started crying. So, overall, it was not a pleasant flight.

Fortunately, it was not a full flight and Janet had the whole row to herself. I had the seat next to me open and there were plenty of open seats towards the back of the plane. Janet had pre-ordered some wine and a burrito for each of us. These items came early. Otherwise, it was just the standard snack and complementary soda item.

We got home to Sacramento about 8:00pm, retrieved our luggage and walked to the car. Leaving the car was an extra $200 plus, but at least it started right up.

Making it home after 9:00pm we finally made it to bed after 10:00pm. Woke up early, but at least we are home.